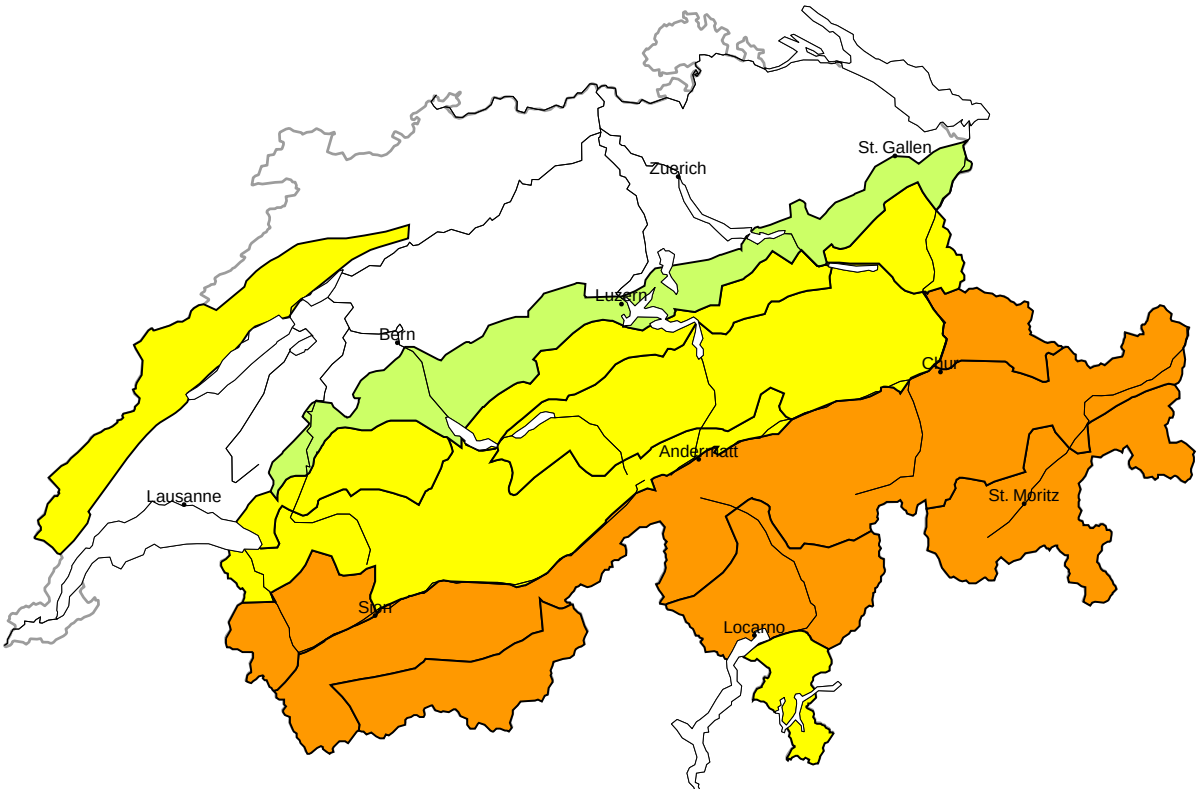
Avalanche danger

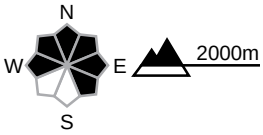
updated on 9.2.2026, 17:00



region A — Considerable (3+)

Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

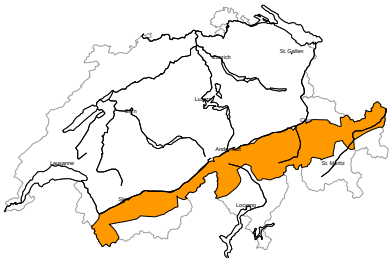


Danger description

Distinct weak layers in the old snowpack necessitate caution and restraint. Avalanches can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size in isolated cases. The avalanche prone locations are prevalent. Remotely triggered avalanches are to be expected. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack and fresh avalanches indicate the danger.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger and restraint.

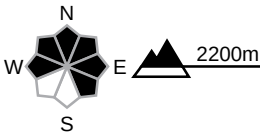
Danger levels 1 low | 2 moderate | 3 considerable | 4 high | 5 very high

region B — Considerable (3=)



Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

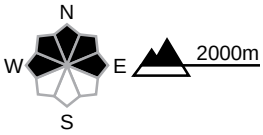


Danger description
Weak layers in the old snowpack necessitate caution. Even single snow sport participants can release avalanches. These can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size in isolated cases. Remotely triggered avalanches are possible. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack and fresh avalanches can indicate the danger.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

region C — Considerable (3=)

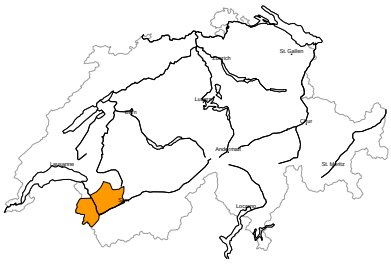
New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



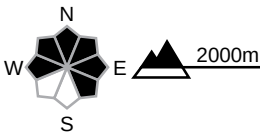
Danger description
Over a wide area new snow is lying on a weakly bonded old snowpack. Even single snow sport participants can release avalanches. These can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size in isolated cases. Remotely triggered avalanches are possible. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack and fresh avalanches can indicate the danger.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

region D — Considerable (3-)



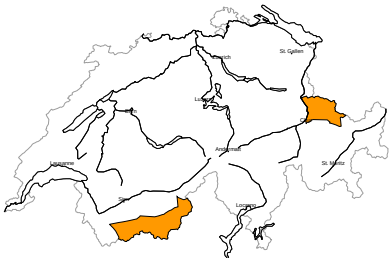
Wind slab, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



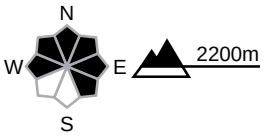
Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. Avalanches can be released, even by a single winter sport participant. Avalanches can additionally in some places be released in deeper layers also. These avalanche prone locations are to be found in particular at transitions from a shallow to a deep snowpack and in little used backcountry terrain. Mostly avalanches are medium-sized.
Backcountry touring calls for careful route selection.

region E — Considerable (3-)



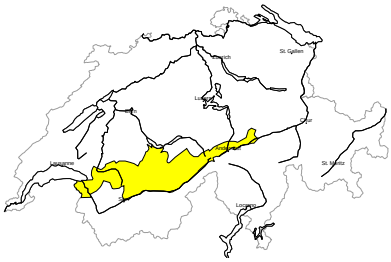
Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



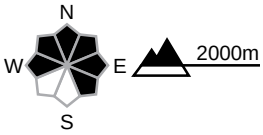
Danger description
Weak layers in the old snowpack necessitate caution. Even single snow sport participants can release avalanches in some places. These can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size in isolated cases. Remotely triggered avalanches are possible in isolated cases. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack can indicate the danger.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

region F — Moderate (2+)



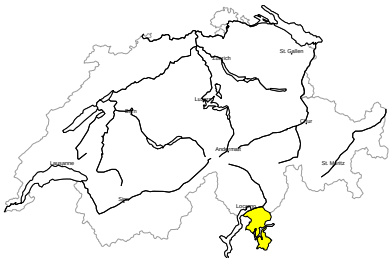
Wind slab, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



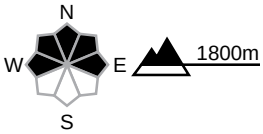
Danger description
The fresh and older wind slabs are in some cases prone to triggering. Avalanches can additionally in some places be released in the old snowpack also. These avalanche prone locations are to be found in particular at transitions from a shallow to a deep snowpack and in little used backcountry terrain. Avalanches can reach medium size.
Backcountry touring calls for careful route selection.

region G — Moderate (2+)



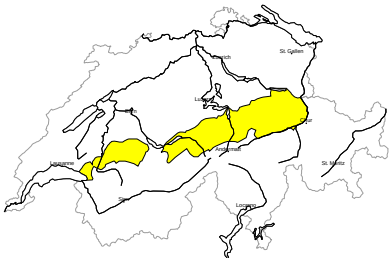
New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



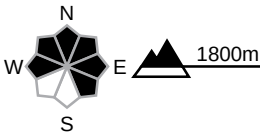
Danger description
The new snow is lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. Avalanches can in some places be released by a single winter sport participant. Avalanches can be triggered in deep layers and reach medium size.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for defensive route selection.

region H — Moderate (2=)



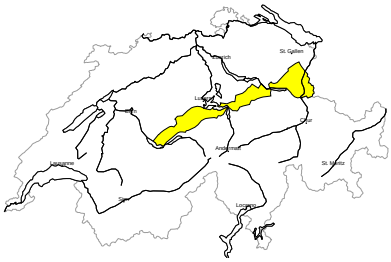
Wind slab, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



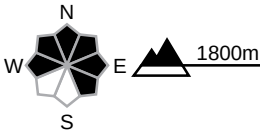
Danger description
The fresh and somewhat older wind slabs are in some cases prone to triggering. The avalanche prone locations are to be found in particular in gullies and bowls, and behind abrupt changes in the terrain. Avalanches can additionally in isolated cases be released in the old snowpack also. These avalanche prone locations are to be found in particular at transitions from a shallow to a deep snowpack. Small and, in isolated cases, medium-sized avalanches are possible.
Careful route selection is recommended.

region I — Moderate (2-)



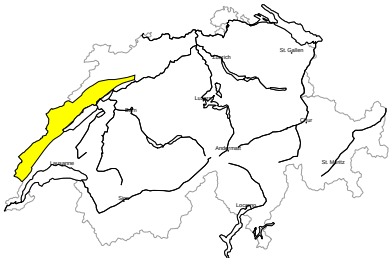
No distinct avalanche problem

Avalanche prone locations



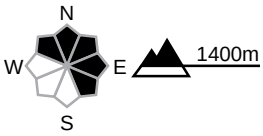
Danger description
The near-surface layers of the snowpack can be released in some places in particular at transitions from a shallow to a deep snowpack, when entering gullies and bowls for example. Mostly avalanches are rather small. Careful route selection is recommended.

region J — Moderate (2-)



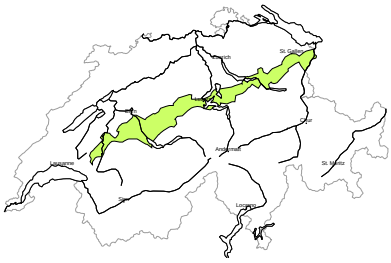
Wind slab

Avalanche prone locations



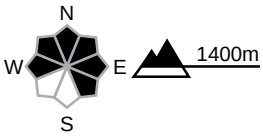
Danger description
As a consequence of new snow and a sometimes strong southwesterly wind, mostly small wind slabs will form. They are to be evaluated with care and prudence in very steep terrain. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

region K — Low (1)



No distinct avalanche problem

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Individual avalanche prone locations are to be found in extremely steep terrain. Mostly avalanches are only small but can be released in isolated cases by a single winter sport participant. Restraint should be exercised because avalanches can sweep people along and give rise to falls.

Snowpack and weather

updated on 9.2.2026, 17:00

Snowpack

Snowpack structure is unfavourable in many locations in southern Valais, Ticino and Grisons, with distinct weak layers that are prone to triggering in the middle and lower part of the snowpack. Whumpfing sounds and avalanches triggered by human activity, often remotely, continue to be reported from these regions. Snowpack structure is somewhat more favourable on the northern flank of the Alps and in northern Valais, but there are weak layers deeper in the snowpack in these regions too. These may still be triggered, especially where there is little snow and at transitions from a deep to shallow snowpack.

Weather review for Monday

Conditions were very cloudy in the south, with light snowfall above approximately 1400 m. Elsewhere, there were sunny intervals in the mountains, with cloud thickening from the west.

Fresh snow
On the central part of the southern flank of the Alps a few centimetres above 1400 m

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, around -3°C

Wind
Moderate southeasterly winds at times on the Northern Alpine Ridge, otherwise mostly light

Weather forecast to Tuesday

In the north, conditions will range from cloudy with bright intervals to very cloudy, with the brighter intervals primarily occurring in the Visp valleys and Grisons. In the south, conditions will be very cloudy. Some precipitation is expected, especially in the west and south. The snowfall level will be between 1000 and 1500 m.

Fresh snow
- Jura, extreme west of Lower Valais, northern Valais, central part of the southern flank of the Alps: 5 to 15 cm
- otherwise a few centimetres, dry in central Grisons and the Engadine

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, between -2°C in the north and -5°C in the south

Wind
Increasingly moderate southwesterly, strong in the west

Outlook for Wednesday and Thursday

On the southern flank of the Alps, both days will see cloudy skies with bright intervals and some precipitation. In the north, conditions will be very cloudy, with repeated precipitation, which will be centred in particular in the west and on the northern flank of the Alps. More than a metre of fresh snow is expected in westernmost and northern Lower Valais, otherwise 70 to 100 cm on the northern flank of the Alps west of the Reuss and in Lower Valais, 40 to 70 cm on the northern flank of the Alps east of the Reuss and in Upper Valais, elsewhere less. The snowfall level will drop from 1800 m to 1200 m in the north and will be at 1300 m in the south. The wind will often be strong to storm-force from westerly directions. Avalanche risk will increase rapidly and significantly to level 4 (high) on Wednesday in many areas on the western part of the northern flank of the Alps and in Valais. Avalanche risk will increase in other regions too, most notably on the rest of the northern flank of the Alps, in the Gotthard region and in northern Grisons.